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Learning About Children's Lives: A Note On Methodology

When I was a little girl growing up in Southern Spain, my grandmother, who was a font of knowledge on Spanish oral traditions, liked to teach me about the complexities of life and other important things that, as she used to put it, I was not going to learn at school. One of the ways in which she used to do this was by teaching me *refranes* (proverbs and popular-lore aphorisms), but always with an ironic twist or addition of her own that would make it clear that there are always different points of views for any given situation. Perhaps because there is nothing like the ethnographic process to highlight the perspectival dimension of experience, rarely have I found myself remembering my grandmother's *refranes* and quips more than during the time I spent in Vallenuevo. And at a time when I often worried about how I was perceived, and should or could be, perceived by others in this fieldwork town, I could hear my grandmother saying, *el hábito no hace al monje* (the habit doesn't make the monk), to which she always added with a tongue-in-cheek, yet earnest expression, *pero ayuda a reconocerlo* (but it certainly helps to recognize one).

With this in mind, I made it a point from the beginning to go into the community with all my research equipment in tow, as much as possible and as often as possible, with the hope that eventually I would come to be seen as a fixture of the place, equipment and all, and accepted as an established researcher. As an ethnomethodologically- oriented linguistic ethnographer, however, that meant walking around the town, going into public buildings and into people's houses, not only with a notebook and pencil in hand, but also with audio- and video- recoding equipment, as well as a tripod and a still camera. I did this even when I knew that I was not going to be using any or most of these tools, again hoping that over time, I would become identified with my equipment, and that, when the time came to use it,

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people would not find it so strange or off-putting. I also did this because I wanted to confront as early as possible people's reactions, questions, and doubts about who I was and what I was doing in their town.

I decided that the best way to let the community start getting to know me would be while I was also getting to know every corner of the town where I was going to spend at least the next 12 months. During the first few weeks of fieldwork, in addition to formal introductions and networking visits to a variety of institutions and social services, I made it a habit to take long walks around the town, taking pictures of buildings and street signs; talking to retired people perched on benches in the town's main square about the beautiful sixteenth-century church; marking sites of interest on commercial or self-sketched maps; engaging groups of mothers in the park in casual conversation about the best places to go shopping or to get an afternoon coffee, and so on. Needless to say, everyone also had plenty of questions for me. Not everything about initially introducing myself to the community, however, went as smoothly. There were also challenges that I had to overcome, but in working through those challenges I learned valuable lessons not only about managing my ethnographic positioning in a community that was hyper-aware of its own prominent place in regional and national discourses about Moroccan immigration, but also about some of the tensions that from time to time would bubble up to the surface.

I can still recall vividly, for instance, people's looks, ranging from mildly amused and curious to slightly wary, vis-à-vis my own sense of awkwardness, the first couple of times I went out in full gear for these long walks around the town. I was often approached by groups of children, probably daring one another, who, while giggling and exchanging furtive glances with each other, would finally gather up the courage to ask me "Eres de la tele?" ("Are you from TV?"). My misrecognition as a reporter happened most frequently during the first months of fieldwork, but it remained a common occurrence throughout my stay, especially when I encountered people who did not know me. While some of my recording equipment might have helped locals place me in that identity category, Vallenuevo, as I have already mentioned in Chapter 2, had been the object of national media attention for its seemingly successful integration of a heavy concentration of Moroccan immigrants in a relatively short period of time. Once the town had become "a story," many journalists, as well as scholars and researchers, such as myself, did in fact continued to come to Vallenuevo, intrigued by these favorable reports, wanting to investigate further how processes of immigration were evolving here. Just in the time I spent in Vallenuevo, the town was visited by two national television crews, one radio program, and one team of reporters who published an in-depth extended article in a national newspaper, in addition to being the object of dozens

of short news stories in both the national and regional press. This was indeed a high degree of interest in a rural town with less than 11,000 people.

A second related aspect that these initial walks revealed was that this attention in itself constituted a problem for a handful of Spanish locals who resented outsiders' focus on Moroccan immigrants. For this reason, whether or not a real journalist, I, as an outsider who came to the town to study Moroccan immigrant children, also had to contend with some of these negative reactions. The most intense encounter I had happened the third week after I moved to Vallenuevo. I was taking one of those long walks, and found myself at a junction near the main park, as I tried to figure out how to get to a small *librería-papelería* (bookstore and stationery shop) that I had found on a previous outing. I approached a middle-aged woman with two bags full of groceries who was waiting for a traffic light to change, and asked her for directions. Although she told me how to get to the shop, it was obvious that she was regarding me with some suspicion, and at some point, asked me directly whether I was a journalist. I told her that I was not, but before I had a chance to say anything else, she continued: "En el pueblo estamos hartos de periodistas que vienen aquí a grabar a los moros" ("In this town, we are sick of journalists who come here to record *los moros*"). As the traffic light changed, she walked away still fulminating, while I remained on the corner a bit startled and without knowing how to react. Such angry outbursts, although few and far between, tipped me off early during fieldwork about the existence of complex dynamics brewing below the surface. This was particularly important at a time when most people had yet to show any willingness to speak to me on the record about Moroccan immigration beyond safe platitudes. It also allowed me to see clearly that studying Moroccan immigrant children in Vallenuevo was going to involve more than gaining the trust of the children and that of their caregivers; namely, that my success learning about the children's lives was also going to depend, to a large extent, on how gracefully I would negotiate my ethnographic positioning in the community and on how carefully I would navigate very sensitive local politics. In this chapter, I discuss the methods of data collection and analysis that I used to investigate Moroccan immigrant children's lives. In doing so, I place special emphasis on how I negotiated my own position in the different social contexts where I observed the children.

3.1 A Methodological Overview

This study is based on a total of 16 months of fieldwork in the town of Vallenuevo (12 consecutive months between September 2005 and September

2006, and four months in the summer of 2007[1]), during which, I participated as fully as possible in the daily lives of the children and the community.[2] Data collection for this project included various ethnographic methods: (1) participant observation; (2) ethnographic interviewing with children, teachers, and caregivers; (3) video-recording of children's naturally-occurring interactions with their parents, teachers, peers, siblings, doctors, and other community members; (4) transcription of video- and audio-recorded data; (5) collection of lifemaps produced by the focal children; (6) collection of site texts and documents concerning education, language, and social services; and (7) collection of newspaper and magazine articles featuring the community of Vallenuevo from the mid-1990s until 2007. To investigate how Moroccan immigrant children negotiate the racialized politics of difference and belonging in their everyday lives, it was crucial to observe and record these children's participation in linguistic and social practices, as well as in everyday routines across a wide variety of contexts. As Schieffelin (1990, p. 1) has argued, the study of children's "speech activities that organize and give meaning to [their participation in] the give and take of everyday life" is key to understanding how "through language, they create social relationships between themselves and others."

Children's points of view were also documented through longitudinal, ethnographic interviews. This method was used to illuminate Moroccan immigrant children's emergent understandings of their own lives, as well as their sense of developing processes of identification. These interviews were critical to my own understanding of just how aware children were of the processes of exclusion and racialization that I document in this study, as well as of the varied situational expectations that others had of them. The combination of interviews and interactional data is a powerful way of grounding the meanings of sociocultural processes in both the realm of participants' subjectivities, as well as in social processes of interaction among individuals. As Sapir (1949, p. 515) reminds us, "the true locus of culture is in the interaction of specific individuals and, on the subjective side, in the world of meaning which each one of these individuals may unconsciously abstract for himself from his participations in these interactions." Furthermore, the concurrent implementation of interviewing methodologies and recording techniques of naturally-occurring activities permits, on the one hand, the examination of beliefs about practices versus how those beliefs and practices are enacted in social action, and on the other hand, the examination of how participants position themselves through narratives about their lives vis-à-vis how they position themselves and are positioned by others as they go about their daily routines. In this sense, comparisons of observed communicative practices with interview data allow the researcher to illuminate the tensions that surface between immigrant children's percep-

tions of their realities and the sociocultural and linguistic fabric of their daily lives.

Finally, when conceptualizing this study methodologically, issues of scale and scalarity had to be seriously considered. In documenting the lives of immigrant children of the Moroccan diaspora in Spain, it was critical to account for private and public; local, global, and transnational; historical and contemporary forces, which, in combination, impinge upon these children's emerging identities in crucial ways. As Hall (2004, p. 118) has noted, ethnographers seeking to understand immigrant children and youth processes of identification and incorporation in modern nation-states beyond traditional models of immigrant assimilation, should implement "a shift in ethnographic vantage point from an exclusive focus on everyday worlds to the broader historical and cultural processes in which these worlds are embedded." Two different approaches allowed me to establish the macro cultural logics through which representations of the Moroccan community were produced, circulated, and organized in social practice: (1) my ongoing informal conversations with a variety of public figures in Vallenuevo, as well as my ethnographic engagement with social agencies and in socio-political events of the community and at the national level; and (2) the collection and study of site documents (related to educational practice and policy, as well as to public policy) and media articles.

This chapter provides an overview of data collection sites, as well as outlining the implementation of research methods explaining their significance in the formation of an integrated, multilayered, ethnographic data corpus.

3.2 Sites of Data Collection and My Ethnographic Role

As a Spanish woman in my early thirties, originally born and raised in a city three hours away from the small town where I conducted my fieldwork, one could easily assume that my positionality relative to the local Spanish population was easier to negotiate than my positionality with the Moroccan community. In some regards, this was true; and my "insider status" accounts for the fact that from the beginning of the study, many local institutions facilitated my arrival and settling-in. In many other regards, however, my relationship with the larger Spanish community of Vallenuevo was somewhat ambivalent and, in a few cases, difficult. In addition to the fact that I was originally from a larger city, I was perceived as a foreign-educated expatriate who had spent the last 10 years living in the United States. But, most

importantly, from some people's point of view, I was in the town solely to study Moroccan immigrants, a concern I alluded to in my opening vignette. Given the complex interethnic relations in this town, that fact did not win much sympathy for my cause among a small group of Spanish locals. Some locals began to identify me as *la amiga de los moros* (the friend of *los moros*). I know that many people who used this epithet did so in a tongue-in-cheek way, trying to tease me or get a reaction out of me, since some of them were also people who were trying to help me. I also know, however, that some others had less than these benign intentions.

Despite the political complexities of studying immigration in such a small, tightly-knit community, the vast majority of Spanish locals did not display any negativity towards my presence in this town, and some of them were extremely hospitable and welcoming, such as Pepa, vice-principal of the school, and her colleagues Paco and Teresa. Pepa, for instance, invited me to join her aerobics class, and introduced me to some single Spanish women with whom I went out for coffee every now and then during weekends or special local celebrations, when they often invited me to a variety of events. These friendships were very helpful in establishing rapport with the Spanish locals, as well in managing my own reputation as a married woman, while working and living alone in the community. As is the case in small communities in many parts of the world (e.g., Besnier 2009), gossip was a major source of information and form of social control in Vallenuevo. As an outsider, I was aware that both the Moroccan and Spanish communities were scrutinizing my behavior. The extra layers of evaluation did, of course, make sense, given that everyone wanted to make sure that someone who worked closely with their children was safe and trustworthy. Another way in which I cultivated my ties and relationships with the local Spanish population throughout the study was to continue to frequently visit those institutions and organizations that had originally facilitated my entry into the community. I would stop at the town hall and the health center a few times a week to greet the employees, the local police, and, particularly, social services which provided assistance to the Moroccan community. I often participated in and volunteered my time for community events throughout the course of the study, such as *talleres interculturales* (interculturality workshops) and *foros por la tolerancia y la convivencia* (thematic conferences about immigration, emphasizing tolerance and living-together), many organized jointly by NGOs and the regional and local governments.

The Moroccan community considered me a "local" Spanish woman, and therefore initially saw me as an outsider. However, I was unlike most Spanish people that the Moroccan community in this town had come into contact with. What set me apart from most Spaniards, in their view, was that I was

a very serious student of both Moroccan and Standard Arabic, with a certain command and fluency in both languages. In addition, I had spent time living in Morocco and was, therefore, familiar with many cultural traditions and some of the habitual ways of doing things in the community. From that standpoint, I was a *nice* rarity and a novelty. I heard several people refer to me as "the friendly woman who speaks good Arabic" (referring to Modern/Standard Arabic). Those facts also helped me establish rapport with Moroccan immigrant families and overcome some initial guardedness about my research, although, among some members of the Moroccan community, those feelings of mistrust continued for several months. After this initial period of wariness, many families soon extended their hospitality to me and regularly invited me for tea, meals, and celebrations (such as naming ceremonies, the breaking of the Ramadan fast, and 'Eid-al-Kabir). While the curiosity that I aroused among many Moroccan families was partly the reason for many initial invitations, I continued to receive them throughout the study (and not just from the families of the focal children) because in their perception, I was not only interested in *recording and interviewing them*, but also genuinely interested in spending time with them outside of my "*official*" role as a researcher. They would tell me that they were pleased that I joined them for daily family events and special celebrations in their households because Spanish people in Vallenuevo did not usually show interest. Indeed, I did enjoy spending many social afternoons, talking over coffee and pastries or Harša (a sweet flatbread made from semolina), with many of the Moroccan women I was getting to know, such as Worda's elder sister and mother, Kamal's mother, and Amina, the wife of Rashid, the Arabic teacher at the public school.

In addition, many Moroccan families showed much enthusiasm about the fact that I had spent time in Morocco and they would often ask me many questions regarding my stay in their country and about the places where I had been. Apart from my research, the families were curious about me personally, especially those aspects of my life that were different from their expectations, such as the reasons why I did not have children or why I lived so far away from my family. When I would briefly relate some of my life circumstances, they very often felt sorry for me. While they could certainly understand having to move for a variety of reasons, including work, most Moroccans I talked to saw this as a hardship, particularly the fact that I lived alone and did not even have any immediate family with me, since the family unit is still a crucial source of social status and identity among Moroccan immigrants in this town. Very often, their immediate reaction was to say, "*muskina*" (Moroccan Arabic for "poor little thing"), and to wish that God would grant me children and a family in the future.

Initially, the children did not know what to make of me. Because I would spend long hours observing them at the public school at the beginning of the study as well as spend time in some of their homes and observe them during the track-and-field team training sessions (where most of the children were of Moroccan origin), they were unsure of my possible status as a teacher. They would often come up to me and ask my name and what I was doing in their town. After those first two and a half months of fieldwork, however, I was rarely questioned by either the children or the parents. As my ongoing involvement with the children, their families, and the community became greater, an increasing feeling of informality developed in our daily interactions, conversations, video-recordings of everyday activities, and video-recorded interviews.

I collected my data in three institutional settings, namely the public school, the health center, and the oratory-mosque. At the health center, the head of pediatrics was immediately supportive of this research project, which she considered important. Therefore, she granted me permission to be at the clinic with a video-camera, provided that I got informed consent from each individual Moroccan family that I was to record. Access to the other two institutional settings was a bit more difficult to negotiate. During the first three months of fieldwork, I was not allowed to enter or undertake any video-recording in the oratory-mosque where the children attended Qur'anic and Classical Arabic classes. I had to meet several times with the leaders of the local Islamic association Assalam, that ran the oratory, before I was granted permission to video-record these classes. At those meetings, I was thoroughly questioned about the purpose and objectives of my research project, about other sites where I was collecting data, about how the data was going to be used in the future, and about my knowledge and opinion about Islam. Through regular discussions with these leaders, they became better acquainted with me and my research, and I was eventually given access to the classes held in the oratory in December. Following the religious protocol of respect in this sacred environment, I wore a headscarf covering my hair and loose pieces of clothing which covered my arms up to my wrists and my legs down to my ankles while video-recording at the oratory.

As Carlos, the principal of the school, told me when he met me, the public school was no stranger to researchers coming and wanting to conduct research with their student population. Consequently, it did not take me long to obtain administrators' permission to observe the children. However, unlike other researchers who had made observations at the school for a couple of months and/or distributed questionnaires to the students, my research involved weekly visits to a number of settings at the school throughout the academic year, and additionally, with a video-camera. Once

these particulars were known, and despite the principal and vice-principal's steadfast support, at the beginning of the study, some teachers were uncomfortable and apprehensive of my research methods, which they considered to be very intrusive. Through both formal meetings and informal conversations with teachers and administrators, I was able to ascertain that the root of their uneasiness had to do with two facts: (1) some teachers were worried that the presence of a video-camera would create havoc among the students and would become a bothersome distraction that would prevent them from accomplishing their pedagogical goals in the classroom, and (2) others were worried that, although I said I was there to document the sociocultural lives of the children, some part of my study might have included teachers' evaluations of some kind. This second worry disappeared over time as more and more teachers learned that the school was only one among many sites for data collection in my study, and that I was also carrying out observations and recordings in children's homes, the health center, the oratory, and the track-and-field club. With regard to the first concern, and to minimize the impact of the video-camera in the normal functioning of classroom activities, I developed a schedule that consisted of two months of daily observations (so that the children would get used to my presence), at the end of which, I began to gradually introduce the camera. Contrary to some teachers' expectations, and to my relief, when I started to videotape regularly, the camera did not cause major excitement or rumpus among the children. Ironically, although teachers, were initially anxious anticipating my video-recording in the classroom, I later learned that the actual video-recording, made them less anxious than when I had sat at the back of the classroom taking notes during the first two months of fieldwork. A couple of the teachers whose classes I videotaped most told me one afternoon over coffee that this was because the quiet note-taking made them wonder what I could possibly be writing about or taking an interest in, while they perceived the subject of the videotaping to be completely obvious and transparent. In addition, apart from the times I visited the school to observe and videotape, I offered my services to the teachers to do substitutions, to help with art projects and special school events that were very taxing on teachers' time, and to accompany teachers on fieldtrips when extra adults were welcomed to supervise the children. I also regularly joined the teachers at social gatherings and celebrations outside the school context. This assistance and conviviality were very much appreciated by the staff, and, certainly, by me as well.

The children's own peer groups were the contexts in which my positionality as a researcher was most difficult to negotiate. Because I wanted to document children's lives as much as possible from the perspective of the children themselves, the peer group was a crucial locus of ethnographic

inquiry. It was also the context in which my status as a foreign adult, however, was more conspicuous since I was observing and recording interactions that usually took place without adult supervision. As Christensen and James (2000, p. 5) have posited, it is in these contexts, when generational issues are bound to take center stage both at the ethical and practical levels, that researchers need to be particularly reflective and mindful of "the ways in which they are being accepted by the children as a particular kind of presence in their normal everyday lives." For this reason, before I actually did any video-recording of peer-group activities, I spent many afternoon hours during the first four months of research, hanging-out with the children in the park or in the street so that, little by little, they would become accustomed to my presence in these settings, gradually introducing my practices of note-taking and photographing their activities. Even though I would converse with the children during these periods of "hanging-out," I established a practice of *non-intervention* in peer-group activities, whether ludic or adversarial.

I followed and documented a group of focal children's everyday routines and activities across a wide variety of institutional and familial contexts and social situations that were central to their lives, including the public school, mosque-oratory, households, peer group, health center, and the track-and-field team. To ascertain similarities and variability in communicative practices across social situations and whether the meanings of such practices change depending on context, it was essential to follow participants in a number of different settings, and with different levels of involvement – from observer to participant – (Duranti 1997). Examining *how* Moroccan immigrant children manage languages and social practices to establish social relationships and to negotiate difference and commonality of belonging was central in this study. It was also crucial to study the co-occurrence of features in various sites; particularly, the co-occurrence of features both in communicative practices and in children's social engagements, as well as how they relate to each other and to the larger context. As Bateson (1972) argues, for meaningful patterns and processes to arise in people's lives, a certain degree of *redundancy* should hold between settings and social situations.

3.2.1 The Public School

The town public school, *colegio de educación primaria* (primary education includes both elementary and middle school), was a key site of data collection due to the fact that, except for weekends and vacations, the children spent a significant amount of their day in this context, interacting with one another, with their Spanish peers, and with teachers. The public school was

also a crucial site because it had come to occupy a prominent role in the achievement of a high degree of peaceful and stable *convivencia* (living-together) in the community. The principal Carlos, a very strong leader and also a very astute politician in his own right, was very aware of this important role, and always considered both carefully, the educational and political ramifications of every decision that was made in the school, including, of course, whether or not to authorize my research. While the principal was always amenable to my project, among the major concerns that he had about my presence in the school was the issue of how to best secure the informed consent of the parents. When I explained that my research would not interfere with the children's regular activities and that, furthermore, I would implement measures to ensure the confidentiality of their children's identity, the principal responded that the biggest problem was how to explain my presence in the school to the local Spanish parents. He further suggested that we might want to explain my research goals as neutrally as possible and to background the fact that I was in the school to investigate primarily Moroccan immigrant children. Bewildered by his response, he proceeded to explain: "Sí, porque los padres protestan y dicen que aquí todo lo que se hace, se hace por los moros. Y no queremos más problemas de los que ya tenemos" ("Yes, because parents protest and say that everything that is done here, is done on behalf of *los moros*. And we don't want more problems than the ones we already have"). He wanted to make sure that my research was not going to be perceived as something special that the school was doing for the sake of the Moroccan students. On the contrary, and if at all possible, he wanted my larger involvement with the school, beyond my specific research goals, to be perceived as something that could potentially be beneficial to all students, Spanish and Moroccans.

After my research in the school was authorized, and before selecting one main classroom in which to do my research, I visited the school's four fourth-grade classrooms. One of the four classrooms was eventually chosen for three reasons. In consultation with Carlos, the principal, I learned that most of the Moroccan children in this classroom had a very low record of sojourning, that is, their families usually stayed in the town for the duration of the academic year and would rarely travel for long stays in Morocco outside official school vacation periods. This was important to minimize participants' attrition during the study. In addition, I had already established positive initial contact with several families whose children were in this particular classroom, which could facilitate my access to the children's lives in out-of-school contexts. The third reason was that the teacher in this classroom was an experienced teacher who was amenable to this research study and who did not show as many signs of discomfort with my presence and the presence of the camera as some of the other teachers had shown.

The total number of students in the focal class was 24, out of which, seven were Moroccan immigrant children: ***Sarah***, Miriam, ***Wafiya***, ***Karim***, ***Mimon***, Jalal, and Yimad.[3] As I will elaborate in Chapter 5, the school had had a long history of addressing the incorporation of Moroccan immigrant children into the Spanish educational system and had received several awards for their work towards social inclusion and program development.

The initial two-month period of observation allowed me to become familiar with the children's schedules and activities, as well as with routine workings of the institution itself. This time also helped me identify the types of classes that I needed to record to obtain extensive documentation of what a typical school day looked like from the point of view of Moroccan children, as well as the venues where video-recording could be complicated. For example, due to the size of the school's three playgrounds and because children were physically very active during recess, I made the decision not to video-record on a regular basis during these leisure periods. However, I did make ongoing observations and take fieldnotes during recesses, focusing on the activities of the focal children. Towards the end of the academic year, however, I was able to videotape a few of the games played by a group of my focal children with their classmates. Some of the Moroccan children in the study followed the regular curriculum along with their Spanish peers in all classes (Miriam, Mimon, and Yimad). Others (Sarah, Karim, Jalal, and Wafiya), however, followed the regular curriculum along with their Spanish peers for only some of the classes, and were withdrawn from their regular classroom for several hours a day for Spanish Literacy and Math enhancement classes. School officials called this *Programa de Educación Compensatoria* (Compensatory Education Program), but colloquially both teachers and children routinely refer to it as *la clase de apoyo* (the support class). For these reasons, I decided to record four types of classes: (1) classes in which only completely mainstreamed Moroccan children were present with Spanish children (Math, Social Studies, and Language Arts); (2) classes in which all Moroccan children (mainstreamed and recent immigrants) were present with Spanish children (Music, and Dance and Performing Arts); (3) the Spanish Literacy and Math enhancement class from the Compensatory Education Program that the four non-mainstreamed Moroccan children attended; and (4) the Arabic Heritage Language class that all seven Moroccan children attended once a week, while their Spanish peers had religious education.

In Vallenuevo, there were two main sites for Moroccan immigrant children to receive instruction in the Arabic language: children attended Arabic language classes in the Spanish public school and in after-school religious classes in a makeshift oratory-mosque run by the local Islamic cultural organization Assalam. As part of the LACM Program, all Moroccan children

in this study attended Arabic language classes once a week at the public school, while their Spanish peers attended Catholic religion classes. The LACM Program[4] (*Programa de Enseñanza de Lengua Arabe y Cultura Marroquí* – "Arabic Language and Moroccan Culture Teaching Program") is a relatively new educational initiative jointly funded by the Spanish and Moroccan governments. Spanish schools' participation in this program is voluntary. The public school in Vallenuevo had been participating in the LACM program for several years. Under the provisions established as part of the agreement, the Spanish government offers logistical support (classroom, office space, etc.) for Arabic language classes to take place in those public schools that apply for it, and the Moroccan government is responsible for the curriculum, as well as for selecting, providing and paying for Arabic language teachers, who, with very few exceptions, come from Morocco. Both the Spanish and Moroccan governments are responsible for designing instructional materials and offering professional development training programs to participating teachers.

3.2.2 The Oratory-Mosque

The small oratory that served the religious needs of the Moroccan community of Vallenuevo was also the setting where Moroccan immigrant children attended after-school Qur'anic classes in the afternoon. The classes were held in a small, separate room at the back of the oratory with a separate exit to the street. Therefore, the children and I never entered through the main door that gave access to the more sacred space[5] of the oratory-mosque, but through the back door on the other side of the building. The classes were divided into two groups: a class for adolescents and older children that met on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Saturdays from 5:00 to 6:00 p.m., and a class for younger children that met on Tuesdays, Thursdays, and Sundays from 5:00–6:00 p.m. This is the class that all of the focal children in the study attended, except for Kamal. No classes were held on Fridays, the mandatory holy day of prayer for Muslims. Since during the weekdays, I was usually busy either at the public school or at the health center, I tended to visit the oratory-mosque during the Sunday lessons. Once I obtained permission to record these classes, I videotaped in this setting every other Sunday. Occasionally, however, I went more or less frequently, depending on whether I traveled to track-and-field meets with the children.

The classroom itself was in state of disrepair: small pieces of the wall were flaking off, the room had only one electrical outlet, and the ceiling leaked in various places when it rained. At the beginning of my recordings, the classroom was furnished with only a few old rugs and a half-broken board that hung precariously from the wall until second-hand desks were

eventually donated. Also, the teachers often did not have enough instructional materials for all the children who attended. I contributed notebooks, pens, and pencils, and a small heater, since the facility got extremely cold during the winter months. The local *fqih* (religious teacher), Bilal[6] and his wife, conducted the classes.

3.2.3 The Health Center

The local public health center is a small-scale clinic that covers the basic medical needs of the town's population. For more serious conditions, births, and surgical operations, patients were referred to specialists in a larger hospital situated in a larger town approximately six miles away from Vallenuevo. At the time, this study was conducted, healthcare in Spain was public, government-run, and free. This included basic healthcare for undocumented migrants, as well as pre- and post-natal care for immigrant pregnant women and minors until age 18, independent of their legal status. All documented immigrants had access to the free public health care system.[7]

Through informal conversations with children, parents, and community members, I soon learned that Moroccan immigrant children often translated for their families, particularly at the local health center. At the health center, attitudes among healthcare personnel towards children's roles as translators were mixed. On the one hand, the staff valued children's efforts, and how much children's work as interpreters facilitated their work as healthcare professionals. On the other hand, and mirroring popular beliefs towards language brokering, doctors and nurses would also tell me that they disliked this practice because they felt it was putting too much responsibility on the children. In fact, they tried to eliminate it by hiring a professional interpreter in the mornings. There was no interpreter available in the afternoon or in the evening hours, however, when the local health center and its emergency unit was still operative. This was when Moroccan children would often accompany their families and neighbors to perform interpreting services. When, after four months in the field, I approached the clinical staff and requested permission to record medical visits involving Moroccan children who translated in the afternoon hours, they were very supportive of my study. Doctors were particularly interested in knowing whether or not children felt uncomfortable performing these tasks and the difficulties they had doing translations.

Working with one pediatrician, Rocío, and her nurse in particular, I went to the health center once every two weeks. The pediatrician and her nurse were extremely generous in informing me in advance about which day of the week they would have more appointments with Moroccan families. This set of data, however, is the least systematically-recorded, and due to several

reasons, it involves a large number of non-focal Moroccan children. This was due partly to the unpredictability of medical needs and/or children's availability to act as language brokers in these encounters. There were also other constraints, such as the fact that I had to obtain the permission of each individual family before recording the medical encounter. Since I started recording at the health center after being in Vallenuevo for four months, many families already knew me personally or knew of my research. These families almost always granted me permission to record their interactions. There were a number of families, however, who either did not know me at all (particularly those who came from nearby small villages) or who were uncomfortable with me recording their interactions. As a result, I was sometimes unable to videotape even a single medical consultation at the clinic, whereas other times, I was able to make recordings of several families in one visit. I sometimes missed a recording because families did not always attend their scheduled visits.

The clinic's staff had actually developed a theory as to why families missed their appointments so frequently. They guessed that because medical care in rural parts of Morocco was probably limited and expensive, many immigrant families had developed *una mentalidad de supervivencia* (a survival mentality) regarding health. Doctors often told me that they needed to help the families change this survival mentality into one more compatible with preventive health care and regular visits to the clinic. Although I do not dismiss the doctors' hypotheses, I also suspect that some Moroccan families missed appointments for other reasons, including tiring, double shifts during the harvest seasons. Appointments were also probably missed because some families had trouble reading letters from the clinic. Often during my study, I observed parents asking their children to help them decipher such letters, since the household was another site where language brokering occurred on a regular basis. Many times, parents would also bring out these letters for me to translate during visits to focal children's homes, in the hope of getting me to tell them exactly when they had to take their children to the doctor, for what reason, and what paperwork they needed to bring with them. Although observing how families worked together to translate these letters was part of the interactional dynamics that I was hoping to capture, I could not, of course, refuse to help with translation when families had so graciously welcomed me into their homes.

3.2.4 The Households

I usually visited the households of all focal children once a week. Initially, I was treated as a high status guest. Therefore, it was very difficult to determine the normal routines of the household that the children participated

in. However, after spending a few months with them, families began to relax during my visits, conducting themselves in a more casual manner. It was then when I was able to document children's involvement and participation in the homes. Key practices, in which children, particularly girls, participated included doing house chores (such as cleaning, washing clothes, cooking), and translation of letters and documents.

One of the most difficult aspects of videotaping in the homes was video-recording family meals and afternoon teas without directly being asked to participate in them. For the Moroccan families I spent time with, it was extremely embarrassing to have me present in the room and to not have me join in on the meals and interactions. It took many months in Vallenuevo and weekly contact with focal families for a few of them to agree to such recordings, and for them not to insist during those recordings that I take part in the activity. For some Moroccan families the idea of having me in the household without participating in the meals or celebrations continued to be an unthinkable notion, bordering on the absurd. Such being the case, on certain occasions, I actually decided to record these activities with me as one of the participants, to which the families did not object as long as I joined for lunch, tea, or whatever was being served. This technique also allowed me to see whether or not there was any difference in families' behavior and practices between these meals and the meals in which I was videotaping the families alone. This comparison, however, had limitations in that it involved different families. Similarly, many families found it strange that I wanted to videotape when mothers and girls were working together preparing the food or tidying up the house. They would asked me, genuinely perplexed, whether it would not be better to *take pictures* or *make a video*, as they often referred to my videotaping activities, once the house was already clean and the food ready for presentation. Whether videotaping or not, I always wrote extensive notes as soon as I finished with each of the home-visits.

Eventually, in addition to regularly observing these activities, I was able to videotape at least a few instances of all of the practices I have just described, namely girls' participation in chores; translation events; sibling interactions; family meals; and afternoon teas. Video-recording in the homes of the focal children was, however, uneven. For example, I was only able to video-record activities in the homes of four of the focal children, those of Sarah, Worda, Karim, and Kamal. Wafiya's family never gave me permission to video- or audio-record them. Every time I asked for their permission to record, Wafiya's parents and elder siblings would talk with embarrassment about the precarious conditions of the lower-level garage in which they lived. And they would add that, if they lived somewhere else or if they managed to move to a better house, I would be welcomed to

record. These situations were not uncommon. When I first established contact with Kamal's family at the beginning of the study, they lived in what used to be the business premises of an old local butcher's shop. While this space was barely fit for a family of four to live in, Kamal's mother could not afford to rent anything else. Often, when I visited this family during the first few months of the study, we had to sit around a table having tea or dinner by the light of several candles. A few months later, thanks to a subsidy and two part-time cleaning jobs that Kamal's mother was able to secure, the family was able to move to a spacious apartment where I was able to visit often and to videotape. Mimon's family was always very reluctant and uncomfortable with the presence of a video-camera or any kind of recording device in the household, even though, unlike Wafiya's family, they lived in a very nice townhouse. Although they were always very cordial to me, they specifically told me that I had permission to record Mimon at school, at the mosque, and outside the home, but not inside.

3.2.5 The Peer Group

Given the amount of out-of school-time that Moroccan immigrant children in Vallenuevo spent playing and interacting with other children, peer-group communicative and social activities were crucial in this study. Although I started documenting and observing peer-group practices from the very first weeks of study, for reasons I have mentioned above, I did not videotape these activities until four months into the project. This initial period of observation allowed me to get a general sense of the importance of peer-group cultures in these children's lives: I studied the sociocultural organization of peer-group activities, as well as the compositions of the groups; I learned about their favorite games and how they were played, and in general about peer-group routines and the children's most common meeting places. Specifically, there were three types of places in the town where focal children would concentrate for their games: on the street near their houses, in the local park, and in a couple of vacant lots of land scattered around the town. This last piece of information proved to be crucial when I began systematically recording the peer-group activities. Although as the study progressed, I would ask the focal children in the school whether and where they were going to play on a given afternoon – and often they would let me know where they were going to be playing – many times the chosen location was unpredictable. And I spent many afternoon hours wandering around the town until I would find the location where the children were playing, especially at the beginning of the study. Once I established a recording schedule, I videotaped peer-group activities once a week, alternating between the different peer groups to which the focal children belonged.

This alternation mostly meant that I followed the extended peer networks of two of the most sociable and well-liked focal girls (Worda and Wafiya), on the one hand, and the networks one of the most charismatic focal boys (Kamal), on the other hand. Their convivial demeanor and large number of friendships allowed me to connect to a large number of children and their interactions, including other focal children (such as Sarah), and children that I had the opportunity to get to know in other contexts (such as Yimad, Jalal, and Manal).

Unlike other sites of data collection (such as the school, the mosque, the households, or the clinics), where children were (and expected to be) under adult "supervision," my presence in peer-group games and activities stood out more conspicuously. At the same time, however, my daily presence in so many other contexts of their lives, and my lack of directly interfering with the children's routine activities in these other contexts, also helped to normalize somewhat my observations and recordings of peer-group games and practices. During the course of the recordings, I adopted the role of observer and minimized my participation in any of the activities that the children themselves organized in the context of their interactions with peers; for instance, I never elicited any speech or form of language use. Also, I never directed or made decisions regarding peer-group games or activities, even though, particularly at the beginning, the children would ask for my input or invite me to take part in their games quite frequently. While it is not uncommon for children to want adult researchers to participate in games or to act as an arbiter in their disputes, children also tried to involve me in their activites in a way that I had not anticipated before I undertook this study: during the first couple of video-recordings, when children were trying to confront other children's alleged game rule violations, they turned to me and asked whether they could review the violation in question to determine who was at fault, if anyone. The first time this happened, it created a comically awkward moment for me, not only because the children caught me off guard, but also because, although I had to deny their request, I could not help but visibly delight in the cleverness of their idea. As the process of data collection went along, however, all these behaviors began to disappear. This was mainly due to two facts: (1) the focal children grew accustomed to my daily presence and my recording of their everyday activities; so, even the novelty of the camera lost its initial appeal; and (2) the focal children also began to trust my promise of confidentiality, when they realized that I was not reporting any of their peer-group activities to any of their adult caregivers, particularly those activities the children *could get more in trouble for*, such as fights, use of *bad* language, *inappropriate* gossip about adults, or play con-

versations fantasizing about adult-like topics, such as going out to nightclubs or having girlfriends/boyfriends.

On a few occasions, however, some children participating in these activities, particularly friends of the focal children who were not as used to my presence and systematic observation, continued to try to recruit my intervention in games and ongoing interactions. This happened especially when conflict and disagreement erupted among themselves, but, sometimes, also for ludic purposes. Even for this handful of occasions, I reminded the children that I was interested in knowing how they played and learned together, and I did not intervene in any subsequent course of action that children took, including those involving fights. More interestingly, in these few occasions, the focal children themselves reprimanded the other children for trying to involve me in their games and disagreements, telling them to leave me alone and reminding them that, when I was recording with my videocamera, I was *an invisible ghost*, a trope that I had previously used with the children in the initial stages of my interactions with them during data collection.

Although children's activities during the track-and-field training sessions cannot be considered *per se* peer-group activities, since they are supervised by adults, namely two male coaches and several parents who would accompany the children on and off to some of the most geographically removed competitions, children also enjoyed free, relatively unsupervised periods during the training sessions, bus journeys, and in between competitions. Unlike the local soccer and indoor soccer clubs whose membership was dominated by Spanish children, Moroccan immigrant children made up the majority of the local track-and-field team. Given the international record of success that Moroccan athletes have attained in track-and-field competitions, it is not surprising that so many Moroccan children in the town were interested in the sport. I suspect, however, that the appeal of this club for Moroccan immigrant children had much to do with the fact that one of the coaches, Félix, had a strong commitment to fairness and equality and was a passionate advocate of the benefits of sports for children. He strongly encouraged the Moroccan immigrant children to join the track club, even going to great lengths to find sponsors for those children who could not afford the equipment and travel expenses.

Given the large number of Moroccan immigrant children who were part of this athletic club, I asked the coaches of the team whether I could observe the children at practices. Although both coaches were very helpful from the beginning, Félix was particularly enthusiastic about my study, sensing, I think, that he had found another person who shared his concern about the welfare and education of children. I began attending training sessions once

a week almost from the beginning of the study. My involvement became more intense when I discovered that three of the children who eventually became focal children in the study (Worda, Wafiya, and Kamal) were members of this club. By the beginning of winter 2006, I also started traveling on the weekends with the team to many of the athletic competitions that occurred during the year. As my involvement with the team grew, I became a volunteer helper to the coaches, helping to supervise the children's training, cheering the children on during competitions, photographing the team with their winning medals, and in general, doing whatever I could to facilitate the club's activities. I made a deliberate choice to minimize my videotaping in this context. I did this in part because training and competitions did not easily lend themselves to videotaping, given that both children and accompanying adults were literally doing much running around, but also because I wanted to develop a more informal and intimate type of relationship with the children during these recreational activities. Indeed, my ongoing presence on the team allowed me to develop a very close bond with the three focal children and their teammates, and to establish excellent rapport and trust with many other Moroccan children and families in the town. Of course, I did take extensive fieldnotes of children's activities and interactions, but I usually wrote these up in the quiet of my apartment after the practices and competition trips. On a number of occasions, however, I did videotape activities that I thought were representative of peer cultures in the track and field club, such as unsupervised interactions during practice or between races. This allowed me to develop at least a partial video record of the track-club activities that I could add to my general corpus of video-recordings.

3.3 Participant Observation and Recording of Naturally-Occurring Interactions

Bernard (2002) has identified participant observation as the foundational method of any anthropological endeavor, which he defines as being "both a humanistic method and a scientific one. It produces the kind of experiential knowledge that lets you talk convincingly from the gut . . . It also produces effective, positivistic knowledge" (pp. 322–323). Participant observation can range on a continuum from complete observer to complete participant. In this ethnographic study, I adopted the mixed role of participant observer: at times, I was fully taking part in some aspects of the community and children's lives going on around me, such as my involvement at the track-and-field club. At other times, I adopted a more distanced

role, recording practices and events as they unfolded without my active participation, such as when I was behind the camera videotaping lessons or visits to the doctor. In this sense, participant observation was a fluid process that led me to reflect on how my dual role might have affected the research context and the data collected in the process. During observations and recordings, there were moments when I definitely thought that my presence was affecting the behavior of those around me. For instance, during my initial visits to the children's homes, I was always treated as an *honored* guest. Consequently, the families stopped the normal routines of the households and all interactions and activities centered upon my presence in the house. Oftentimes, the families would go to great lengths to enact an appropriate reception, wearing their best garments and preparing elaborate meals. Although these initial visits were critical to establish close bonds with the children and their families, my active social participation in these social gatherings, as well as the way I was being positioned by the families, preclude me from using these interactions in most of my analyses of family practices, except for those having to do with cultural practices of hospitality. At other times, in the midst of videotaping, I had to stop being an "observer" and become an important "participant," such as the time when a child injured himself seriously during play or when, on one occasion in the health center, a child was translating the wrong dose of antibiotics to be given to a sick baby.

Video-recording was crucial to this study for several reasons.[8] The video-recording of social practices facilitates a multifaceted analysis of linguistic practices enriched by kinesic details and material environments that are essential for the examination of face-to-face interaction (e.g., Goodwin 1993). Video-recordings allowed me to investigate the interactional achievement of social and linguistic practices, and to identify and contrast patterns within these practices at a level that would not have been possible otherwise. In addition, I supplemented the video-record with site documents, field notes, and my own ethnographic diaries collected and written throughout the study. In these field notes and diaries, I recorded my daily observations and informal conversations with various members of the community. A total of 86 hours of video-recorded data were collected. The number of hours and categorization of the data according to the social setting in which they were collected are summarized in Table 3.1 below.

Video-recorded data and transcription are central to the ethnomethodological analysis that I have conducted in Chapters 5, 6, 7, and 8 of this book. In Appendix 1, I describe how I worked with this type of discourse data and how I constructed the transcripts. In Appendix 2, I provide a list of the symbols I used to transliterate Arabic speech into the Roman alphabet.

Table 3.1 Number of hours of video-recording.

Social Settings	Number of Hours
Public school	28
Mosque	12
Households	13
Peer group	11
Health center	3
Track-and-field and other social settings	4
Interviews	15
Total number of hours of video-recordings	**86**

3.4 Ethnographic Interviews

I used two different types of interview methods in this research study. The first kind was the semi-structured interview conducted with the focal children's parents and some teachers at the public school, namely the head teacher of the fourth-grade class, Guadalupe, whom I followed and recorded throughout the academic year, as well as Rashid, the Arabic heritage language teacher at the public school. These semi-structured interviews yielded important insights about attitudes, values, and ideologies surrounding the linguistic and sociocultural practices that I was observing and recording. As Duranti (1997, pp. 103–104) reminds us, however, ethnographers need to be particularly mindful of the cultural ecology of interviews, since "reactions to the researcher's questions will vary, depending on [. . .] the extent to which the interview format fits into local practices of obtaining information." This consideration was critical in my study because, whereas teachers seemed to be very comfortable with the interviews and, in many ways, expected to be interviewed in the context of my research study, Moroccan parents seemed ill at ease and more awkward about responding to my questions in formal interview situations. In contrast, Moroccan parents were more relaxed during our informal conversations, answering my questions, providing information, and often discussing with me, even without being prompted, difficult and problematic aspects of their lives, of their relationships with their children and with the community at large (both Spanish and Moroccan). Even though I conducted these semi-structured interviews during the later stages of the research to ensure a maximum degree of trust between the parents and me, during formal interview situations, many of them still appeared stiff, nervous, and, even a little apprehensive of going

"on the record" to discuss topics that they had already shared willingly and unselfconsciously in informal conversations with me. To my surprise, some parents even contradicted themselves in these semi-structured interviews, going to great lengths to depict rosier characterizations of situations that they had previously discussed as challenging, and trying to minimize the impact of events that, on other occasions, they had described as being the source of a great deal of pain and distress. Because of the awkwardness that formal semi-structured interviews caused, I made the decision that the best way to obtain information from parents was to continue to hold informal conversations with them during my weekly visits to the households, and to write extensive notes about these conversations as soon as possible after my visits had ended.

Because an important aspect of this study was to investigate how the children themselves portrayed and made sense of their lives, the second interviewing method I used was an open-ended *person-centered approach*. This approach allows participants themselves to steer the interview process and to provide accounts of how they experience their lives, moving beyond treating participants as mere cultural informants (Levy and Hollan 1998; Hollan and Wellenkamp 1996; Hollan 2001). Unlike other interview methodologies, in the person-centered approach, individuals who are interviewed take on a more agentive role in the ethnographic process. As Hollan (2001, pp. 48–49) has noted, since a main focus of person-centered interviewing is on how an individual's subjective experience both shapes, and it is shaped by, sociocultural processes, "an effort is made to represent human behavior and subjective experience from the point of view of the *acting*, *intending*, and *attentive subject*, to actively explore the emotional saliency and motivational force of cultural beliefs and symbols (rather than to assume such saliency and force), and to avoid unnecessary reliance on overly abstract, experience-distant constructs" (emphasis mine).

Because very close and ongoing contact is necessary before people are willing to take part in the kind of frank and meaningful interviews that the person-centered approach advocates, I did not start this kind of interviewing with focal children until I had been in the field for six months. In addition, this method questions the role of the ethnographer and emphasizes the importance of rethinking the dynamics of the interview in the ethnographic process. These factors are critically important in my study since, unlike other studies where person-centered interviewing had been implemented (e.g., Klein 2007), participants in my longitudinal, in-depth interviews were young children. Mayall (2002), for example, has discussed at length how power differential and generational issues can be of great consequence when holding any kind of conversation or interview with children. In my case, I had to think through these issues carefully and closely review past interviews

for self-monitoring purposes, especially given the agentive role that children were supposed to take in person-centered exchanges (where the interviewer is dissuaded from shaping participants' talk or nominating subjects for discussion), and given that children were being asked to offer their reflections of, emotions about, and moral perspectives on their everyday lives and activities.

To lessen power disparities and to allow the children to take as much control as possible during the interview process, I often started the interviews by replaying for children some of the recordings that I had made with them in previous weeks, or by asking general questions about certain events of their lives for which I was not present (i.e. a training session, a class, a special celebration). Also, at the beginning of the interview series, I encouraged the children to draw *lifemaps*, a method adapted from Orellana (2001), which consists of a combination of drawings and brief text captions produced by the children. In addition to tapping into children's views of how their lives could unfold, *lifemaps* are also powerful artifacts of self-representation. Often, I would use these *lifemaps* as a springboard to move discussions along during interviews. Because successful person-centered interviewing entails high levels of meaningful and voluntary involvement from participants, I did not implement this methodology with all focal children. Although all focal children were interviewed at least once throughout the study, only those who expressed genuine interest in participating in a long-term series of interviews were selected for this segment of the study. Person-centered interviews were conducted with Kamal, Sarah, Worda, and Wafiya over a period of five months. In addition to these four focal children, I also interviewed children of other families that I became close to for shorter periods of time. In particular, I want to highlight the contributions of Manal and Abdelkarim to this interviewing process, both of whom were extremely articulate and forthcoming, and whom I quote in several parts of this book.

As part of the methodology, interview materials were mined for recurring themes, points of continuity and contradiction, and issues that materialized as significant for the children. Even though I privilege children's quotidian practices and social interactions as the keystone of my ethnomethodological analysis, interview materials are crucial in several respects. First, one of the premises that underpin this book is that the Moroccan immigrant community in Spain is positioned in a very specific category of exclusion informed simultaneously by anti-immigrant sentiment, contemporary geopolitical discourses about Muslim populations, and historical discourses of *Moorish* invasions. The interviews were a powerful record that revealed just how much Moroccan immigrant children are aware of the racialization of their own immigrant community and how they make sense of this exclusion on a daily basis. Second, interview materials also proved to be invaluable

to determine to what extent those interactional processes that I, as an analyst, was identifying as meaningful in children's everyday social engagement, were also salient to the children themselves, and if so, what aspects were more significant to them. Third, and finally, because I was hoping to develop as holistic a picture of the children's lives as possible, the interviews allowed me to better understand the depth of children's emotional reactions to daily occurrences. This level of understanding would not have been possible by attending to the interactions alone, since rules of social conduct often require that we stifle our depth of feelings about particular situations. In this same vein, through interviews, I was also able to obtain personal information about the children and families that enabled me to have a deeper understanding about the way interactions would unfold in certain cases. For example, one of the children's fathers had been involved in illegal activities, and indirect references to this situation came up in a couple of aggravated fights I observed between the children in a way that directly affected my understanding of the meaning of the interaction for the children participating in the fights.

3.5 Collection of Site and Press-Media Documents

While in the field, I obtained many locally available documents that provided information about the lives of the Moroccan diaspora community in Vallenuevo. For instance, from the regional government, I obtained a copy of the *Plan Integral para la Integración Social de Inmigrantes* (Comprehensive Plan for the Social Integration of Immigrants). From the local authority, I was able to gather actualized census population figures in the town, by both age and national origin. From numerous social services in town, I collected a handful of Spanish-Arabic bilingual brochures advertising institutional campaigns and forms of social assistance available, as well as training booklets for social workers who were being trained to provide services to local immigrants. The brochures were helpful in examining how sociocultural institutional knowledge and norms were presented to the Moroccan community. The booklets were informative of institutional ideologies underlying local construction of immigrants' needs and rights, in addition to providing information about kinds of cultural knowledge about Moroccan immigrants that social workers were expected to have and enact in their dealings with their immigrant clients.

The public school principal, Carlos, generously allowed me to photocopy several of the school's curricular guides and documents pertaining to the internal structure of the school and its vision. These documents were

instrumental, for instance, for me to recognize the schism that existed between official curricular statements and policies about inclusion, and the social dynamics that I observed among Spanish and Moroccan children at the school on a daily basis. Several teachers also allowed me to photocopy instructional materials from books and handouts that were used during many of the classes that I recorded, and which I used to supplement the video-record. These materials provided useful information about teaching methodologies, the skills, knowledge, and values to be taught, and the ideologies organizing knowledge and values. In addition, I consulted the newspaper archives in the local library of a nearby larger town to retrieve articles published about Vallenuevo in the local and national press from the mid-1990s to 2007. I used these materials to ascertain how life in the town and Moroccan immigration had been characterized and portrayed. They were also a valuable source of information for learning what some of the public figures whom I knew (i.e. the school principal, the town mayor, and several social workers) had told the press about the Moroccan community and the town. Very often, I used these articles and statements as starting points for informal conversations with these figures to probe their views and/or shifting perceptions about the social and demographic changes in the town.

I have, thus, used a variety of methodologies and approaches to capture as completely as possible the complexity of Moroccan immigrant children's everyday experiences and concerns in Vallenuevo. Although the following chapters usually focus on only one of the social contexts of children's lives, it is important to note that my analyses of these specific social settings are always informed by the larger body of data as a whole.

Notes

1 The first 12 consecutive months of research were funded by a Wenner–Gren Foundation Individual Dissertation Research Grant (Grant # 7296), and the four months in summer 2007 by funding from a Harry and Yvonne Lenart Foundation Graduate Research Travel Grant, and by a UCLA Center for European and Eurasian Studies Summer Dissertation Research Grant.

2 In addition, during the summer of 2004, I conducted a preliminary pilot study that was designed to lay the groundwork for this research. This preliminary research had three purposes: (1) to identify a suitable site, (2) to make initial contact with the community with which I would be doing my research and (3) to gather ethnographic information on the lifeworlds of recent Moroccan immigrants from the perspective of educators and social workers who interact closely with the children and their families. The preliminary study consisted of ethnographic interviews of teachers and social workers, and observation of several meetings of Arabic heritage language instructors in several areas of Southwestern Spain. This

preliminary study was crucial in order to identify (a) institutional reflections on Moroccan immigrant children's attempts to manage multiple cultural and linguistic expectations, (b) their possible roles as cultural brokers and interpreters for their households, and (c) the challenges that they face in different settings (i.e. household, peer group, educational institutions). Whereas this pilot fieldwork focused on institutional and adult perspectives of Moroccan immigrant children's lives in Vallenuevo, the later research focused on these children's life-worlds from the perspective of the children themselves and their caregivers.

3 The names of the children bolded and italicized are those children who eventually became the focal children of this study. As for the other two focal children, Worda was placed in another fourth-grade group, and Kamal attended sixth grade at the same school. On a couple of occasions, I was granted permission by the teachers of these classrooms to record a few classes in which Worda and Kamal were present.

4 The LACM Program was first implemented in the 1985–1986 academic year. Although the impact of this program is still limited, currently, schools from roughly 25 provinces (out of the 52 Spanish provinces) participate in this program, offering Arabic Language and Moroccan Culture classes either during regular school hours or as a formal after-school enrichment program. For more information about this program, visit http://www.educacion.es/cide/jsp/plantillaAncho.jsp?id=inn07.

5 This area was reserved for prayer and Friday services.

6 Unlike the previous *fqih* (whom I met only once during a Ramadan dinner), who was said to be harsh and have a proclivity towards physical punishment, Bilal was an extremely patient man and kind to the children. Although some of the focal children discussed with me their reticence about attending the classes for fear of physical punishment, I never observed any instance of physical punishment during my recordings. Bilal explicitly told me that he was against it, and the children never complained about him physically punishing them as they had done when talking about their previous teacher. Bilal was always very friendly to me during the recordings and informal conversations.

7 In 2012, the Spanish government implemented a reform of the public healthcare system such that, while pregnant women and minors still receive medical care independent of their legal status, undocumented immigrants no longer have access to basic health care and can only use the public health system in emergencies. In addition, documented immigrants must also pay a supplement for their medicines and certain medical services like any other Spanish resident.

8 I used a medium-sized, three-chip, digital video camera, enhanced by a powerful shotgun microphone, and at times, by a wireless microphone placed in strategic locations, for most of the video-recordings of naturally-occurring interactions. In a few environments however, where the use of this camera proved to be very cumbersome, I used instead, a smaller digital camera that I otherwise used for photographic documentation. In the public school, the oratory-mosque, and the health center, I used a tripod, while I recorded outside activities of the peer group or the track-and-field team training sessions using a monopod. The monopod was much more portable and allowed me to follow more easily (yet steadily), children's high mobility during games.